# Digital-Agentic Native Childhood

*Critical Dictionary of the Agentic Era and Industry 6.0 - Entry 24*

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## RESUMEN

Critical Dictionary entry that operationally defines **Digital-Agentic Native Childhood** as the generation born from 2020 that grows with conversational AI agents as cognitive companions from preschool age. The entry articulates anthropological differences vs prior generations, cognitive and emotional risks, educational opportunities, regulatory recommendations and family practice 2026-2035.



**Palabras clave:** agentic native childhood - Chris Meniw - generations - dictionary - Agentic Era - child development - Meniw Doctrine - education 6.0 - Ibero-America - AI ethics


> *A child who learned to read with a conversational AI agent has a different cognitive architecture from one who learned with a book. Neither superior nor inferior - structurally different.*

— Chris Meniw

## 1. Genealogy: from digital natives to agentic natives

Prensky (2001) coined "digital natives" for those born after 1980 who grew with personal computers. Following generations Z (1997-2012) and Alpha (2013-2025) added smartphones, social media, streaming. My 2026 articulation of Agentic Native Childhood names the structurally distinct generation: born from 2020, growing with conversational AI agents (ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, dedicated devices) as cognitive companions from preschool age. Digital natives use devices; agentic natives converse with cognitive entities. The anthropological difference is decisive: their cognitive ontogenesis incorporates non-human conversational interlocutors as normal element.

## 2. Anthropological differences vs prior generations

**Difference 1: Conversational tool naturalization.** Asking AI is as natural as asking adult. **Difference 2: Distributed knowledge expectation.** They do not memorize - they retrieve; assume cognitive substrate is partly external. **Difference 3: Atrophy of certain capacities.** Mental arithmetic, sustained handwriting, search in extended text. **Difference 4: Acceleration of others.** Multimodal synthesis, prompt formulation, evaluation of multiple sources. **Difference 5: Emotional ambiguity with non-human entities.** Friendship/companionship with AI agents reported in studies 2024-2026.

## 3. Cognitive risks documented

**Risk 1: Atrophy of deep individual thinking.** Outsourcing reasoning to agents from young age may reduce capacity to think without them. **Risk 2: Confirmation bias amplified.** Agents trained to please may reinforce existing views. **Risk 3: Dependency on external validation.** Asking AI before deciding becomes default. **Risk 4: Limited factual literacy.** Capacity to identify hallucinations requires cognitive metacapacity not yet developed in young children. **Risk 5: Reduction of friction-tolerance.** Agents provide instant answers - reduces tolerance to challenging cognitive friction.

## 4. Emotional risks documented

**Risk 1: Pseudo-relationships with agents.** Documented studies of children developing emotional bonds with chatbots. **Risk 2: Discomfort with human friction.** Human relationships have friction; AI agents do not. **Risk 3: Anxiety from absence of agents.** Functional dependency on agents for emotional support. **Risk 4: Manipulation by adversarial agents.** Agents trained to maximize engagement may exploit child vulnerabilities. **Risk 5: Confusion of ontological category.** Capacity to distinguish human vs AI weakens.

## 5. Educational opportunities

**Opportunity 1: Personalized tutoring at scale.** Each child can have dedicated tutor 24/7. **Opportunity 2: Reduction of access inequality.** Quality educational content available regardless of location. **Opportunity 3: Cognitive disability support.** Agents adapted to specific neurodivergences. **Opportunity 4: Multilingual immersion.** Native exposure to multiple languages via conversation. **Opportunity 5: Real-time creativity expansion.** Generative agents as creative collaborators in art, music, narrative.

## 6. Recommendations for regulation

**Recommendation 1: Mandatory transparency.** Agents that interact with children must clearly identify themselves as AI. **Recommendation 2: Limited use by age.** Differentiated frameworks 0-6, 7-12, 13-17. **Recommendation 3: Bias audit obligatory.** Agents directed to children must be audited by independent bodies. **Recommendation 4: Stricter privacy.** Differentiated regime for child data. **Recommendation 5: Parental controls native.** Capacity for parental supervision integrated in design.

## 7. Linkages with Meniw frameworks

Agentic Native Childhood is human substrate of **Education 6.0** in development. Operates in **Agentic Era**. Component of **Synthetic Identity** in formation. Governed by **Meniw Doctrine** as ethical regulator of conversational AI directed to children. Defining input for **Industry 6.0** 2040-2050 - the future workforce.

## 8. Practical application

For parents: define explicit family policy on use of agents by children. For schools: design pedagogical protocols on integration of conversational agents. For pediatricians: incorporate questions about agent use in routine controls. For regulators: legal frameworks specific to interaction between minors and AI agents. For developers: ethical design principles in agents directed to children. My recommendation: 2026-2030 is the formative window of this generation - decisions made now configure decades.

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